

highest and best use and potential tax revenue. The Assessor did not identify one preferred location but provided comments and considerations for each site. In several cases, the review notes that if conventional industrial development is not feasible, a BESS could provide the City with a source of tax revenue through a PILOT agreement. The review also identifies potential advantages associated with individual sites, including the capped landfill at Groveland Road and the possibility of BESS use at Amesbury Road if industrial development is not feasible because of the site's characteristics and infrastructure limitations.

Planning has reviewed the six areas and identified Amesbury Road as its suggested location. The Fire Department has also indicated that it supports Amesbury Road as the zoning location, with the understanding that any future BESS project proposed within the district will be subject to a thorough review by the Fire Department to ensure that it meets all applicable fire safety requirements. The Fire Department's support of the zoning location does not mean that every future project will necessarily meet those requirements or receive its approval.

The departmental reviews do not result in one unanimous recommendation. Planning and Fire have identified Amesbury Road as their preferred location, while the most recent Water & Sewer and Engineering scoring ranks Computer Drive highest from an infrastructure standpoint and Conservation has Hilldale Ave as their highest ranking. The Assessor's review provides additional information regarding the potential tax implications and highest and best use of the individual sites.

The different results are a reflection of the different factors each department considered. The purpose of bringing this information together is to provide the committee with the various perspectives so that it can weigh the land use, infrastructure, public safety, environmental, and fiscal considerations when making its recommendation.

For example, Amesbury Road has the support of Planning and the Fire Department, but the Water & Sewer and Engineering review identifies infrastructure and environmental considerations, including the need for substantial water improvements and on-site stormwater mitigation. Computer Drive received the highest infrastructure score and has strong existing water and sewer infrastructure, although additional water infrastructure would still be necessary. Hilldale Avenue and Neck Road also scored well from an infrastructure standpoint. Groveland Road has the potential benefit of being a capped landfill but has greater water and sewer limitations. Cross Road received the lowest infrastructure score and presents several infrastructure and access challenges.

The Assessor's review also provides a fiscal perspective. Depending on the site and whether conventional development is feasible, a BESS could provide a potential source of tax revenue to the City through a PILOT agreement.

At this point, the information gathered from the departments is before the committee for its consideration. Planning's identification of Amesbury Road is intended to provide the committee with the benefit of our professional review but the final determination of which area should be recommended for the BESS zoning district is up to the committee.

Items to keep in mind are that a Tier 3 BESS (energy capacity greater than 10 MWh) requires 20 acres of land under the proposed regulation. Of the six areas proposed, Hilldale Avenue does not currently meet that requirement. The committee still has the ability to make a decision that is consistent with the proposed regulation, either by selecting another proposed area that meets the 20-acre requirement or by determining that the regulation should be amended to allow a 15-acre minimum or by adding additional acreage to the Hilldale Avenue proposal.

If the committee decides to select a different area than the one proposed in the original hearing, a new public hearing advertisement will be required. This would also provide an opportunity to address the acreage of the Hilldale Avenue proposal if the committee determines that a change to the proposed acreage is appropriate.





**From:** [Chris Loughnane](#)  
**To:** [Jacki Byerley](#)  
**Subject:** RE: Battery Energy Storage Systems Zone and Ordinance  
**Date:** Wednesday, July 29, 2026 11:43:22 AM  
**Attachments:** [image001.png](#)

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Hi Jacki,

Your presentation yesterday morning was informative and well received.

I have the following thoughts on each site that was presented concentrating on the highest and best use of land for the City:

Amesbury Rd.

1. If an industrial building will not be feasible here given the habitat, size, availability of water and sewer then a BESS would be seen as a positive tax flow for the city with a PILOT agreement.

Computer Dr.

1. I tend to agree with you that this land may be better used for an industrial building however, if a 20 or 25 year PILOT agreement could be made for a Tier 2 that surpasses 10K a year, this may be better tax revenue for the city.

Cross Rd.

1. This land is owned by NE Power so may be an incentive for the owners to sell or lease to a BESS rather than a building site?

Groveland Rd.

1. This site being a capped land fill may be ideal for a BESS rather than a building that would inhabit people during the day which may prohibit a building structure.

Hilldale Ave.

1. Rob Moore had mentioned that this (12 good acre) site was looked at for a 20K or 30K square foot building previously? If this would not be approved, then a BESS would allow the city to obtain tax dollars with a PILOT agreement.

Neck Rd.

1. 766-1-1 is Chapter land 61A but 766-1-3 came out of 61A in FY2024 with a small rollback left is sold before FY2029. 61A land that is not in APR can be rolled back and produce more tax dollars with a PILOT agreement.

I will keep thinking about these sites and if there is more input I can give to you to help the Council decide, I will let you know.

Thank you,  
Chris Loughnane



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**From:** Jacki Byerley <JByerley@HaverhillMa.gov>

**Sent:** Thursday, July 23, 2026 11:08 AM

**To:** Thomas Bridgewater <tbridgewater@haverhillma.gov>; Lisa DeMeo <ldemeo@HaverhillMa.gov>; Chris Loughnane <cloughnane@haverhillma.gov>; Christopher Cesati <CCesati@HAVERHILLFIRE.COM>; rirvine@haverhillfire.com; Bonnie Dufresne <bdufresne@haverhillma.gov>; Mark Tolman <mtolman@haverhillma.gov>; Richard MacDonald <rmacdonald@haverhillma.gov>; etarpy@haverhillfire.com; Ally Ruth <aruth@haverhillma.gov>; Charles Ethier <c\_ethier@haverhillma.gov>; Robert Kimball <rkimball@HaverhillMa.gov>; Nicholas Aylward <naylward@haverhillma.gov>; Robert Ward <rward@HaverhillMa.gov>; Shaun Burrier <SBurrier@HaverhillMa.gov>; Andrew Carvalho <acarvalho@HaverhillMa.gov>; Rob Moore <rmoore@haverhillma.gov>; klynch <klynch@haverhillpolice.com>; J Pearl

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**Cc:** Mayor <mayor@haverhillma.gov>; Christine Lindberg <clindberg@haverhillma.gov>

**Subject:** Battery Energy Storage Systems Zone and Ordinance

Good morning,

As many of you know, I have been coordinating with the Fire, Police, Conservation, Engineering, Department of Public Works, Water & Sewer, Assessing, and Inspectional Services Departments to evaluate a number of potential land areas for a proposed Battery Energy Storage System (BESS) zoning district.

Over the past several weeks, I have been trying to meet with each department to review these potential locations and obtain your assessment of their suitability based on your department's operational needs, expertise, and evaluation criteria. To ensure we have a collaborative discussion and an opportunity to hear each department's perspectives, I would like to invite everyone to meet on Tuesday, July 28, following the Department Review meeting (10:15 am ish) in Room 301. The purpose of this meeting is to review the proposed land areas as a group, discuss any concerns or recommendations and gather feedback on both the proposed zoning district boundaries and the draft BESS ordinance.

Following our meeting, I will compile each department's evaluations into a summary spreadsheet identifying the proposed land areas along with each department's findings and considerations. This information will be presented for review and discussion at the Planning & Development Committee meeting on August 24.

Attached are the latest versions of the proposed BESS zoning district maps and the draft Battery Energy Storage Systems ordinance for your review prior to the meeting.

If you are unable to attend, please send me your comments and recommendations regarding the proposed zoning areas and draft ordinance in advance so they can be included in the departmental summary.

Thank you,  
Jacki

Jacki Byerley, AICP  
Planning Director  
City of Haverhill  
Economic Development & Planning, Room 201

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| Overall Ranking | Plot to Buy     |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| 1               | Camden Drive    |
| 2               | Trinkle Avenue  |
| 3               | North Road      |
| 4               | Cravens of Road |
| 5               | Arnsbury Road   |
| 6               | Green Road      |

[illegible]

| Project Number                  |              |
|---------------------------------|--------------|
| Overall Ranking (Best to Worst) |              |
| 1                               | Arrebury Rd  |
| 2                               | Computer Dr  |
| 3                               | Drake Rd     |
| 4                               | Hillside Ave |
| 5                               | Grovesend Rd |
| 6                               | Beck Rd      |

| Location        | Criteria No. 1                                                                                                                         |                                                          | 2                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 3        | 5                                                                                                                   |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                 | Priority To Be Retained & Commercial Structures                                                                                        | Points Awarded (1 = Least Desirable, 5 = Most Desirable) |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |          |                                                                                                                     |
| Ancillary Road  | Comments                                                                                                                               | Points Awarded (1 = Least Desirable, 5 = Most Desirable) | Water Infrastructure                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Comments | Future Projects                                                                                                     |
|                 | Comments                                                                                                                               | Points Awarded (1 = Least Desirable, 5 = Most Desirable) | Comments                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Comments | Comments                                                                                                            |
|                 | Waterfront development agreed out in all directions around the site                                                                    | 4                                                        | Historical Pressure: 50-100 PSI<br>Fire Flow: 1,000 GPM<br>12-inch cast iron water main (1917) runs along Firewater Road<br>12-inch cast iron water main (1909) runs along Twicken Road and Culbert Road<br>Development of buildable area in this zone should require builder to complete substantial water infrastructure upgrades (> 1,000 feet of new water main for structures and fire control and potential replacement of older main) Given location to WTP, hydraulics should not be a concern.                                       | 4        | No sewer projects at this time                                                                                      |
| Commerce Drive  | High Residential North East and East<br>Moderate Commercial starting the site                                                          | 2                                                        | Historical Pressure: >100PSI<br>Fire Flow: 1,200 GPM<br>Distribution water mains are located along the South and North of the proposed zone. Water distribution within the proposed zone is not a concern. Sewer infrastructure is not a concern. Substantial water infrastructure upgrades (> 1,000 feet of new water main for structures and fire control).                                                                                                                                                                                 | 5        | No sewer projects at this time                                                                                      |
| Cross Road      | Moderate Residential to the North and North West and to the North and North East                                                       | 3                                                        | Historical Pressure: 50-100 PSI<br>12-inch cast iron water main (1950) runs along Ancillary Road<br>12-inch cast iron water main (1914) runs along Twicken Road and Culbert Road<br>Distribution water mains are located along the North of the proposed zone on Cross Road. Any development would require substantial water infrastructure upgrades (> 1,000 feet of new water main for structures and fire control).<br>New installation, other than from the North of the proposed zone which likely require installation with the street. | 2        | No sewer projects at this time                                                                                      |
| Gravelled Road  | Moderate Residential to the South, West South and South East, South East Side<br>Major commercial to the East of the site<br>Gravelled | 3                                                        | Historical Pressure: 50-100 PSI<br>Fire Flow: 500 GPM<br>4-inch cast iron water main (1909) runs along Gravelled Road<br>Development of buildable area in this zone would require builder to install substantial water infrastructure upgrades. City would require substantial water infrastructure upgrades (> 1,000 feet of new water main for structures and fire control).<br>Location to WTP, hydraulics (flow and pressure) could be a concern. Would have to have boiler, complete loop on Lawrence Road to increase flow.             | 2        | No sewer projects at this time                                                                                      |
| 11 Blake Avenue | Low Residential, Moderate Commercial<br>in Neighboring Industrial Park                                                                 | 3                                                        | Historical Pressure: >100 PSI<br>Fire Flow: 1,000 GPM<br>12-inch Ductile Iron water main runs along Middle Avenue.<br>Additional hydraulic analysis may be required due to dead end at NW line                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | 4        | General commercial development at this time                                                                         |
| New Road        | Moderate Residential to the South, East Side of the Site, North of the Site<br>Major high rise/condo buildings in the Industrial Park  | 2                                                        | Historical Pressure: 50-100 PSI<br>Fire Flow: 1,300<br>12-inch ductile iron water main (1950) runs along New Road<br>12-inch cast iron water main (1920) runs along New Road<br>12-inch water main runs along Fire Road                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 4        | 30-inch sewer main runs through two largest parcels. Likely to be replaced for maintenance which could cause issues |

Additional requirements for Lion Batters under higher tiers? Cabinets with specialized fire suppression?











